JOAN'S KITCHEN

Penhallow Family Recipes

typed by Joan Penhallow
Madison, Christmas 1995

For David and Karin, for Carol,
and for the grandchildren to come.

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Facsimile made for the Flyleaf sample family. The booklet and its cooks are fictional; the recipes are traditional.

CORNISH PASTIES (EDITH'S WAY)

As Mother Penhallow made them on the farm at Dodgeville. Makes 6.

PASTRY

3 cups flour, 1 teaspoon salt
1 cup lard (or half lard, half butter)
about 1/2 cup ice water

FILLING

1 lb beef skirt or round steak, cut small – never ground
3 medium potatoes, sliced thin
1 small onion, chopped
1 cup rutabaga, sliced thin (the old people called it turnip)
salt and plenty of pepper
butter

Rub the lard into the flour and salt until it looks like meal. Add the water a little at a time and press into a ball. Chill one hour. Divide into 6 and roll each piece to a round the size of a dinner plate.

On one half of each round lay potato, rutabaga, onion and beef, seasoning each layer. Put a dot of butter on top. Fold over, crimp the edge tight, and cut a small slit in the top.

Bake at 400 F for 15 minutes, then at 350 F for about 40 minutes more, until golden.

Edith always said never grind the meat and never put in carrots. Bob liked ketchup on his, which she pretended not to see. – J.

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SAFFRON BUNS

1/2 teaspoon saffron threads, soaked overnight in 1/4 cup hot water
1 package dry yeast in 1 cup warm milk
4 cups flour, 1/2 cup sugar, 1 teaspoon salt
1/2 cup butter and lard together
1 cup currants, 1/4 cup candied peel

Rub the fat into the flour, sugar and salt. Add the yeast milk and the saffron with its water, and knead to a soft yellow dough. Work in the fruit. Let rise until double, about 2 hours. Shape into 18 buns, rise again, and bake at 375 F about 20 minutes.

HEAVY CAKE

2 cups flour, 1/2 teaspoon salt, 1/4 cup sugar
1/2 cup butter
1 cup currants
milk to mix

Rub the butter into the dry things, add the currants and enough milk for a stiff dough. Pat out 1/2 inch thick on a greased sheet. Score the top in a criss-cross, like a fishing net, and sprinkle with sugar. Bake at 375 F for 25 to 30 minutes. Cut in squares while warm.

Mother made this every Saturday in Mineral Point. She said the fishermen's wives at home baked it when the boats came in. - J.

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RUTH SOLBERG'S LEFSE

4 cups riced potatoes, cold
1/2 cup butter, 1/4 cup cream
1 tablespoon sugar, 1 teaspoon salt
about 1 1/2 cups flour

Mix the warm potatoes with the butter, cream, sugar and salt and chill overnight. Work in the flour. Roll small balls paper thin on a floured cloth. Bake on a hot dry griddle, turning once, until brown spots appear. Stack under a towel.

Ruth showed me how at Thanksgiving. Mine are not as round as hers. - J.

ANNA KESSLER'S APPLE KUCHEN

1 1/2 cups flour, 1/4 cup sugar
1 1/2 teaspoons baking powder, 1/2 teaspoon salt
1/4 cup butter, 1 egg, 1/2 cup milk
4 tart apples, sliced
cinnamon sugar; 1 egg beaten with 1/2 cup cream

Rub the butter into the dry things, then stir in the egg and milk. Press into a buttered pan. Cover with rows of apple and sprinkle well with cinnamon sugar. Bake at 375 F for 20 minutes, pour the egg and cream over, and bake 15 to 20 minutes more.

From Ruth, who had it from her mother. - J.

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